



# WONNENACHTSEGE

## 30. OSCHDRET, 2016

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ROBERT LUSCH-SCHREIWER (MIT DENKI ZUM BRIAN WEIS)  
REV-D7

*Honoring: Holle*

### Intonation of the Runes

*Each rune intoned thrice: Haagel (Hagalaz), Yaahr (Jera), Laguz*

### Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

#### WONNENACHT AND THE WONNEDANZ

As Sunna's kiss brought increasing warmth and light to the Hatzholz (Heartwood; the physical realm), Holle sent for her ever-loyal servant, Gedreier Eckhart, whose job it was to walk ahead of the Parade of Spirits to warn the living of the fury behind him. Eckhart's love for Holle is as great in death as it was in life, so he flew into the midst of the Host, finding the goddess dressed in white and seated in a wagon being pulled by the souls of nine bulls. The wagon rolled on three great spinning wheels. From each wheel spun a multicolored thread that wove with the the thread from the others, forming a sack of infinite size named Immerraum ("always-room"). The thunderous voices of many found spirits within the sack filled resounded across the heavens.

"I have filled the sack that cannot be filled, and it is time to bring them home," Holle said. "Go forth to Mannheem (the home of humanity within the Hatzholz) and tell the living that they may welcome the Host and that they should be prepared for the visit. Those who remembered and honored my word will be rewarded. After the visit, they are to light two fires and to pass between them. Through that action, they will be renewed. Then you are to go to the Mannheem field, where you will find a lone linden tree under which you may rest until I arrive."

As Eckhart began his journey into the Hatzholz, announcing the return of the Great Lady, Holle took her mighty Sichel (Sickle) and cut the three threads each, using the end of the strands to tie the sack shut.

The Host crossed from the Oschtbledder (Eastern Leaves) into the Hatzholz. Throngs of people, though scared at first, came out to welcome the parade, honoring the arrival of the wondrous Lady. The clamor of spirits filled the high skies as Holle entered Mannheim. The bulls pulled Her wagon through open windows and doors, seeking those who welcomed Her. The orderly homes served as a sign that Her command was obeyed. She filled the homes with bright light that brought such joy to the residents that they broke out in song and dance.

Presently the wagon approached the Mannheim field called Hexefeld, where Holle found Eckhart sleeping within the bark of a linden tree. She sent the southwest wind, Riffel, to awaken him. She instructed Eckhart to lead the Host to Hexefeld and, upon arrival, to cut loose the spirits in the sack. "It is time to meet my sister," she stated.

Eckhart did as he was told. As the Host of the cosmic spirits approached the field, Eckhart saw another parade descending from the clouds, emerging from the forests, and coming from the soil. Ahead of this parade was a brilliant gray light radiating from a beautiful elderly woman who was also dressed in white. Eckhart approached the woman, recognizing Her as Berchta, and he bowed before Her. He then took the lead through the countryside as the two parades merged together and drew closer to the linden tree where Holle awaited them.

A hush fell upon the Host as the two sisters greeted one another. They embraced, and they began to spin in a dance. The dance spun gentle whirlwinds that touched the Host, bringing warmth and joy to the spirits of the Host, and they, too, began to dance. Some gathered strands and dust from the sack, streaming the strands around trees and scattering the dust on the ground.

The Sisters continued to dance with the Host dancing behind them, moving from the field and over the rivers and lakes. Every being in the water began to dance for joy. The whirlwinds spawned gentle rains that awakened the spirits in the sleeping plants, and they, too, began to dance for joy.

The Dance moved to the foothills, where the Frost Giants had taken refuge from Sunna's breath. As the Host approached, the winter vanished, forcing the Frost Giants to retreat.

On the twelfth day, Holle instructed Eckhart to sleep in a rock at the base of a mountain pillar while the dance continued up a ridge called Hexenkopf. The entourage eventually stopped by a marshy wellspring near the top. The two sisters took rest by the wellspring, and the spirits began to feel drawn to its depths (2).

Holle and Berchta commanded the Host to continue their journey to its end by Holle's home.

Holle led one half of the parade to an elder bush, the roots of which reached beyond the Hatzholz and into the dark realms, taking nourishment from three creeks named Schprudlendi, Gwellendi, and Fliessendi (3). Berchta led the other half to the depths of the wellspring, which emptied into the same creeks.

## THE MILL

The spirits followed the goddesses into these creeks and surfaced in the Holle's meadow, named Bollwies (Flax Meadow), in the Dunkelgegend (4). The spirits followed the goddesses through some woods, passing Holle's home, Es Heisli. They soon entered an open field called Weiwerfeld and soon approached Her Mill.

Holle unhitched the bulls from Her wagon and yoked them to a giant millstone named Seelbrecher ("Soul Crusher"). Behind Berchta, the spirits lined up and entered the Mill, where they would be split apart, never to return in their present form. Holle returned to the joyous Mannheem, taking Her seat upon the Hexenkopf pillar while Eckhart sleeps in a rock. (5)

## BERCHTA LEADS FORTHCOMING SOULS TO UNNERGEGEND

On the other end of the mill, the kernel of the selves of each soul emerged behind Berchta, who then led them up the world tree to the Unnergegend. There they take full form and await their return to the living realms.(6)

Thus, the Bright Half of the Year began and order was restored to Mannheem. King Frost, fearful of losing his grip on the valuable realm, sent his armies to attack (7).

(Note 1: in this story, the wind is coming from the southwest; in another myth, the wind directions are known by their destination rather than their origin. Thus, it is possible that the southwest wind in this myth is known by the name of the northeast wind in the other myth).

(Note 2: Magnetite was common at Hexenkopf and was eventually mined. The most familiar ponds at Hexenkopf currently are ore holes resulting from the mines, but there are also marshy water holes naturally on the mountain that may serve as the reference to the wellspring).

(Note 3: The names of the wells translate to Brimming, Bubbling, and Flowing)

(Note 4: The Dark Realm)

(Note 5: There are reports of a White Lady approaching walkers, carriages, and cars along the top of the pillar, particularly around Walpurgisnacht).

(Note 6: There is more to this segment to appear in the next version).

(Note 7: This is a connection to the Butzemann traditions and the myth of Dunner and the three Frost Giants, Dreizehdax, Vatzehvedder, and Fuffzehfux. At least two versions story have been described frequently under separate cover but will be harmonized either in the next version of this myth or in a separate myth).

## **Es Hollelied**

**Heel Dir, Holle, ed'li Mudder  
Heel Dir Holle, hohi Fraa  
Seele sinne dief im Wasser  
Seele sinne dief im See  
Fedderflocke falle sietsam  
Fedderflocke falle g'lind  
Geb uns gudi Arewet heit un  
Geb uns gudi Arewet nau  
Glitzerend scheine die do Flocke,  
Glitzerend scheint der Schnee im Land.  
Baad mich mol yetz in Deim Brunn do  
Der Brunn bringt mich in Dei Land.**

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### **ROUGH ENGLISH TRANSLATION**

**Hail Thee, Holle, noble mother,  
Hail Thee, Holle, high woman.  
Souls are sensing deep in the water,  
Souls are sensing deep in the sea.  
Feather flakes are falling softly,  
Feather flakes are falling mildly.  
Give us good work today,  
Give us good work now.  
Glittering shine these flakes,  
Glittering shines the snow on the land.  
Bathe me in your well, well brings me to your land.**

**ORIGINAL GERMAN**

**Heil Dir, Holle, hehre Mutter,**

**Heil Dir, Holle, hohe Frau.**

**Seelen sinnen tief im Wasser,**

**Seelen sinnen tief im See.**

**Federflocken fallen leise,**

**Federflocken fallen lind.**

**Gib uns gute Arbeit heute,**

**Gib uns gute Arbeit nun.**

**Schillernd scheinen deine Flocken,**

**Schillernd scheint der Schnee im Land.**

**Bade mich in Deinem Brunnen,**

**Brunnen bringt mich in Dein Land.**

**Original German by Birgit Knorr**

**First public performance: Urglaawe rite to Holle, Trothmoot, 2013**